

Second Conditional

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

The second conditional (if + past simple, would + base verb) is for imaginary or unlikely situations now or in the future. Use it for:

- 1 Hypothetical situations — If I won the lottery, I'd travel the world.
- 2 Advice and imagining — If I were you, I'd tell her the truth.

The past simple here isn't about the past — it signals 'unreal'. Use 'were' for all subjects: If I were rich...

At a glance

Clause	Verb form	Example
If-clause (the condition)	if + past simple	If I had more time,
Main clause (the result)	would ('d) + base verb	I'd learn the piano.

Learning objectives

- Can form the second conditional with if + past simple and would + base verb (CEFR B1).
- Can use it for hypothetical and unlikely situations and for advice with 'If I were you'.
- Can use 'were' for all subjects.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Second Conditional · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. If I ____ the lottery, I'd travel the world.

A. win

B. won

C. will win

D. would win

2. If I had more time, I ____ learn the piano.

A. will

B. would

C. would have

D. can

3. If I ____ rich, I'd buy an island.

A. would be

B. were

C. am

D. will be

4. If I ____ you, I'd apologise.

A. was

B. were

C. am

D. would be

5. If she lived closer, she ____ visit more often.

A. will

B. would

C. would have

D. can

6. If we ____ a bigger house, we'd have a garden.

A. have

B. had

C. will have

D. would have

7. Correct this: 'If I would have a car, I'd drive to work.'

A. If I had a car, I'd drive to work.

B. If I have a car, I'd drive to work.

C. If I would had a car, I'd drive to work.

D. If I will have a car, I'd drive to work.

8. If I had wings, I ____ fly everywhere.

A. will

B. could

C. would have

D. can

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'I don't have money, so I can't travel.'

A. If I had money, I'd travel.

B. If I have money, I'll travel.

C. If I had had money, I'd have travelled.

D. I travel if I have money.

10. It's very unlikely, but if I ____ president, I'd change the law.

A. am

B. were

C. will be

D. would be

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. won** — An imaginary situation takes the past simple in the if-clause: 'If I won'.
2. **B. would** — The result of a second conditional uses 'would': 'I would learn'.
3. **B. were** — In the second conditional, use 'were' for all subjects: 'If I were rich'.
4. **B. were** — The advice form is 'If I were you'.
5. **B. would** — The imaginary result uses 'would': 'she would visit'.
6. **B. had** — The if-clause uses the past simple: 'If we had a bigger house'.
7. **A. If I had a car, I'd drive to work.** — The if-clause of a second conditional uses the past simple: 'If I had a car'.
8. **B. could** — 'Could' can replace 'would' in the result: 'I could fly'.
9. **A. If I had money, I'd travel.** — An unreal present situation takes the second conditional: 'If I had money, I'd travel'.
10. **B. were** — An unlikely situation takes 'were' for all subjects: 'if I were president'.